

The History of Computing

Chapter 1: Early Machines

The first mechanical computers were designed in the nineteenth century. Charles Babbage proposed the Analytical Engine in 1837, a general-purpose machine that could be programmed with punched cards. Ada Lovelace wrote what is considered the first computer program for this machine, long before it was ever built.



Figure 1: Blue box and orange circle

Modern computers process billions of instructions per second. They rely on transistors, tiny switches etched into silicon, which replaced vacuum tubes during the 1950s and made machines smaller, faster and far more reliable than ever before.

Chapter 2: The Internet Era

The internet connects billions of devices around the world. It began as a research project called ARPANET in 1969 and grew into a global network that changed how people work, learn and communicate with each other every single day.

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